



GREEN PUSH
Under Chairman Dinesh Kumar Khara, SBI is creating a framework for green finance

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a cadre of officers who are mostly taken on at the probationary officer (PO) level, SBI in recent decades has had a chairman who has come up through the ranks. Khara, whose tenure will end in October 2023, also joined SBI as a PO in 1984. Interestingly, having its own cadre of officers has not only helped the bank, but also the wider banking industry in the sense that it has now become a factory for producing industry leaders. For instance, YES Bank's current MD & CEO Prashant Kumar; the country's largest depository NSDL's MD & CEO Padmaja Chunduru; and World Bank's MD & Group CFO Anshula Kant are all SBI veterans.

A lot of the credit for its strength in grooming industry leaders goes to the continuous reinvention of HR policies to make its personnel more performance oriented. For instance, under Bhattacharya, SBI underwent a complete HR overhaul with the help of consultant BCG.

The new changes introduced during her time included building specialisation in areas like tech, cybersecurity, risk management, a new appraisal system and building and nurturing its leadership pipeline at all levels. But that is not to say that the bank is averse to tapping the best talent from outside. SBI hired Charanjit Attra—who had stints with EY India and ICICI Securities—as its CFO in October 2020, and appointed Nitin Chugh—who earlier headed Ujjivan Small Finance Bank—as its Deputy MD & Head of Digital Banking in March 2022.

The bank's retail journey has taken a major step forward with the segment now accounting for 42 per cent of its loan mix, and providing its loan portfolio with a lot of stability. Another notable aspect of SBI is its comfortable CASA (current account-savings account) ratio of 44.72 per cent despite offering one of the lowest interest rates in the industry. One reason for this is the strategic